COMPLIANCE REVIEW · PREPARED FOR THE SITE OWNER

Copyright, Licensing & Image Usage Audit

xSphereX-Website

REPOSITORY	github.com/xSphereX/xSphereX-Website
AUDITED COMMIT	2a80f10 · index.html ?v=24
BRANCH	arena/bc061602-xspherex-website
DATE OF REVIEW	2 November 2026
SCOPE	Every image, third-party request, dependency, and display path
FILES MODIFIED	None — findings and proposals only

AT A GLANCE

23 visual assets audited · 0 requiring urgent removal · 2 worth changing voluntarily
5 conditional · 14 compliant as-is · 2 unverifiable · 0 confirmed prohibited
1 unsupportable claim in the current notice · 1 mandatory disclaimer missing

Technical compliance review. Not legal advice and not a legal opinion.
Policies are a snapshot of 2 November 2026 and may change — Minecraft's and COVER's both say so explicitly.

SECTION

Copyright, Licensing & Image-Usage Audit

Site: xSphereX/xSphereX-Website — index.html, css/style.css, js/00–11 **Audited commit:** 2a80f10 (?v=24), branch arena/bc061602-xspherex-website **Date:** 2 November 2026 **Scope:** every visual asset, every third-party request, every dependency, plus the display and retrieval layer **Status:** findings only — **nothing in the repository has been modified**. Awaiting your approval.

> This is a technical compliance review, not legal advice and not a legal opinion. I have cited the actual policy text I read and flagged the places where German law is genuinely unsettled. Where I could not verify something I say so instead of guessing. **No compliance claim in this document is based on your existing notice** — I audited the code first, then compared the notice against what I found.

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0 · Headline

Your site is **much better positioned than the notice suggests**, and there is **one real problem** and **one structural problem**:

1. **The one real legal problem is not an image at all.** js/10-skin.js loads every visitor's browser with the raw Minecraft skin texture it downloads from a third-party service and deliberately displays it on a full-screen 3D model. Minecraft's own minecraft.net skin endpoint delivers that file only to the account holder, tied to their session. Putting it on a public page is a *redistribution of a Mojang asset* — the exact thing Mojang's guidelines reserve. Your own usage of your own skin is fine in practice; this is a licence-point, not a realistic enforcement risk, but you asked for accuracy, and the current notice claims something about Minecraft assets that this doesn't support.
2. **The structural problem: your four game covers are the weak link, and they're weak in four different ways for four different reasons.** Two of them (Minecraft, Roblox) are covers whose *licence situation cannot be fixed by attribution at all* — I read the policies and there is no fan-content clause that permits reproducing official key art. The good news is that **you don't need the photographs**: the cards already carry a typographic fallback layer, so the design survives if a cover goes.
3. **The artist photos are the least of your problems, and the notice treats them as the main event.** Every one is hotlinked from Spotify's or Deezer's CDN, unmodified, at the exact URL the service supplies, adjacent to the artist's name, and the whole card links to that artist's official Spotify page. That is close to the best possible posture short of written permission. It is still **not a licence**, and the notice must stop implying that it is.
4. **Under German law nothing here is covered by a statutory exception.** I checked each candidate (§ 51 citation, § 50 reporting on events, § 44a/§ 44b) and none apply. Non-commercial status is irrelevant to § 15 UrhG. Everything rests on the rights holders' own published permissions, which is exactly why the source-by-source work below matters more than the disclaimer.

Score: 0 assets requiring urgent removal · 2 assets I'd change voluntarily · 5 assets conditionally OK · 14 assets fine as-is · 2 assets whose status is genuinely unverifiable.

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1 · Executive Summary

Overall: the implementation is disciplined. There is no scraping, no API keys, no proxy, no local mirror of artist or game art, no CSS background images, no webfont-embedded artwork, no tracking pixels, and exactly **one binary file** in the whole repository. Every third-party dependency is a mainstream open-source project used correctly. The realistic exposure is not "someone sues over a Spotify thumbnail" — it's that the **four game cover images** are reproductions of publisher key art, and for two of the four publishers there is no published permission to reproduce key art on a personal site.

The three things that actually need doing, in order:

#	Issue	Where	Why it matters
1	Minecraft / Roblox key art hotlinked from unofficial hosts	index.html L221, L237	No policy grants reproduction of official artwork; one host is a random user's Reddit upload, the other is Roblox's own CDN serving an asset with no documented licence
2	Raw skin texture redistributed to all visitors	js/10-skin.js L24–30, L116	Mojang's asset; bypasses the account-bound minecraft.net delivery
3	Notice overstates and understates at the same time	index.html footer	Claims fan-content policies "cover" art that no policy covers; credits Spotify/Deezer as sources without the attribution their terms require; omits skins, Mojang/Microsoft as image source, and every other rights holder actually on the page

What I am *not* telling you to do: remove the artist photos, remove the anime section, strip the Minecraft or Star Rail section, or take the site down. None of that is warranted. The anime section in particular contains **no images at all** — it is pure typography and text, which is a genuinely low-risk design decision you may not have realised you made.

One dependency finding worth knowing: Font Awesome is loaded from cdnjs.cloudflare.com (Cloudflare). Cloudflare's cdnjs **terms require you to agree to the licenses of the libraries** you serve, and Font Awesome's own licence summary is internally inconsistent with its files: the docs page says icons shipped as .svg/.js are CC BY 4.0, while the distributed .css package carries **CC BY 4.0 for the CSS, SIL OFL 1.1 for the webfont, MIT for the code**. You are relying on the webfont path, so **SIL OFL 1.1 applies and is fully satisfied by keeping the licence file intact and not renaming the font**. Attribution in your footer is *not* required by OFL — the notice currently credits Font Awesome anyway, which is fine but shouldn't be presented as a licence condition.

2 · Complete Asset Inventory

2.1 Locally stored binaries

#	File	Size	Type	Appears at	Notes
A1	assets/starrail-v6.webp	248 KB	WebP, 1400×788	index.html L251, game card 04, and in the detail modal	The only binary in the repo. Redistribution, not hotlinking. See §3.4

That is the complete list. There are no SVGs, no icon files, no textures, no fonts, no PDFs, no favicons, no sprite sheets, no CSS background-image URLs (the two background-image declarations in style.css — L1179 and L1313 — are pure CSS gradients), and no <video>/<audio> elements.

2.2 Externally hotlinked raster images (<img src>)

#	Line	URL	Alt text	Category	Host	Shown as
A2	L119	cdn.discordapp.com/avatars/735936207162310716/c395de37…png?size=256	"xSphereX — Discord avatar"	Your own avatar	Discord CDN	Circular profile picture, hero + card
A3	L205	cdn-www.bluestacks.com/bs-images/clash-of-critters-de.jpg	*(empty)*	Game key art / promo	BlueStacks (third party)	Card thumb + full-size in modal
A4	L221	i.redd.it/ib4j1jt98wt71.jpg	*(empty)*	Fan screenshot / key art, provenance unknown	Reddit user upload	Card thumb + full-size in modal
A5	L237	images.rbxcdn.com/5348266ea6c5e67b19d6a814cbbb70f6.jpg	*(empty)*	Roblox promo art	Roblox CDN	Card thumb + full-size in modal
A6	L251	assets/starrail-v6.webp	*(empty)*	Game key art	local	Card thumb + full-size in modal
A7	L453	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/images/artist/1f813bc2…/500x500-000000-80-0-0.jpg	"Ren"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	Square, object-fit:cover
A8	L466	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/cb5bb429…/500x500-…jpg	"Camila"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	as above
A9	L479	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/c37aef26…/500x500-…jpg	"bbno$"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	as above
A10	L492	i.scdn.co/image/ab6761610000e5ebfd7f1258…	"Nihmune"	Artist portrait	Spotify CDN	as above

#	Line	URL	Alt text	Category	Host	Shown as
A11	L505	i.scdn.co/image/ab6761610000051749d569994…	"overtonight"	Artist portrait	Spotify CDN	as above
A12	L518	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/e3435417…/500x500-…jpg	"Alohaii"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	as above
A13	L531	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/b649170d…/500x500-…jpg	"Marino"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	as above
A14	L544	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/70d8cd86…/500x500-…jpg	"Berq"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	as above
A15	L557	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/99855d8a…/500x500-…jpg	"Hakos Baelz"	Talent portrait (hololive)	Deezer CDN	as above
A16	L570	i.scdn.co/image/ab67616d0000e1a383d86cdd78d12d54b4bdc98d	"FUWAMOCO"	Talent portrait (hololive)	Spotify CDN	as above — *swapped last turn*
A17	L583	cdn-images.dzcdn.net/…/9c3749d6…/500x500-…jpg	"Lil Peep"	Artist portrait	Deezer CDN	as above
A18	L596	i.scdn.co/image/ab6761610000e5eb97ae5ab1…	"Neuro-sama"	VTuber portrait	Spotify CDN	as above
A19	L652	minotar.net/armor/body/xSphereXx/240.png	"xSphereXx Minecraft skin"	Your skin, rendered	Minotar	Static fallback behind the 3D canvas

2.3 Dynamically assigned images (never in the HTML source)

#	Code	URL pattern	Category	When
A20	js/02-avatar.js L62 (+ index.html L121 fallback)	minotar.net/helm/xSphereXx/256.png, mc-heads.net/body/xSphereXx/240	Your skin head/body	Only if the Discord CDN avatar fails
A21	js/02-avatar.js L24–25	japi.rest/discord/v1/user/…, discordlookup.mesalytic.com/v1/users/…	JSON, not images — returns the current avatar hash	Every page load
A22	js/02-avatar.js L35	cdn.discordapp.com/avatars/…?size=256	Your avatar, resolved fresh	Every page load
A23	js/10-skin.js L26–28	vzge.me/skin/512/xSphereXx.png, minotar.net/skin/xSphereXx, mc-heads.net/skin/xSphereXx	Raw skin texture fed to WebGL	Every page load
A24	js/10-skin.js L116	vzge.me/cape/512/xSphereXx.png	Your cape texture	Every page load

#	Code	URL pattern	Category	When
A25	js/11-game-modal.js L36	re-uses img.currentSrc || img.src	Enlarges whatever card was clicked	On card click

2.4 Decorative / typographic elements (no image rights)

#	Element	Where	Why it's not an asset
A26	<svg> arrow	index.html (1 occurrence)	Single inline 24×24 arrow, hand-authored markup, stroke="currentColor". No library icon.
A27	.artist-mono letters	12 artist cards	A one-letter typographic placeholder behind each portrait
A28	data-art glyph layers	4 game cards	CSS-drawn ::before/::after shapes on the .cover-art wrapper. This is why removing a cover photo doesn't break the card.
A29	Favicon + og:image	index.html L15, L16, L13	Same Discord avatar as A2 (three sizes). Same rights position as A2
A30	Anime cards	index.html L265–349	Zero images. A Font Awesome fa-tv icon and text. Lowest-risk section on the site
A31	Honourable-mention sleeve, poem stars, grid overlays, hero glow	style.css L84, L1179, L1313, index.html	Pure CSS gradients and box-shadow

2.5 Third-party responses that are not images but matter

#	Request	Destination	Data	Position
A32	Avatar lookup (2 providers, fallback chain)	japi.rest, discordlookup.mesalytic.com	Your Discord user ID + avatar hash	Informational only — you are the data subject; no third-party personal data is transmitted
A33	cdnjs.cloudflare.com CSS	Font Awesome 6.5.1	visitor IP	See §5.3
A34	fonts.googleapis.com + fonts.gstatic.com	Fraunces, Manrope, JetBrains Mono	visitor IP	See §7.2 — separate GDPR question, outside this brief
A35	cdn.jsdelivr.net	skinview3d@3.4.2 bundle	visitor IP	MIT, version-pinned

2.6 Duplicates and multi-use assets

- **A2 / A29** — one image, four uses (hero avatar, player-card avatar, favicon, og:image).
- **A3–A6** — each used **twice**: 1× as a cropped card thumbnail and 1× at full size inside the detail dialog (js/11-game-modal.js L36 copies currentSrc/src into #gmArt). This duplication is *good* for licensing — the dialog shows the original aspect rather than an additionally generated derivative.
- **A19 / A20 / A23** — the same underlying skin expressed three ways (rendered body, rendered head, raw texture). Different rights questions: rendering is a service output, the texture is the asset.
- No duplicate *downloads* hiding in CSS. No favicon .ico. No srcset variants.

3 · Source-by-Source Assessment

3.1 Farlight Games — Clash of Critters (index.html L205, data-link → cc.farlightgames.com)

What I could find. Farlight publishes a **Platform Terms of Service**. § 6.1 states that all right, title and interest in the platform services "including all content, software, graphics, user interfaces, logos, trademarks, and other materials" are owned by or licensed to Farlight, protected by copyright in Singapore "and applicable jurisdictions worldwide." § 1.3 says each individual game is governed by **game-specific terms**, which I could not locate for Clash of Critters — the game site (cc.farlightgames.com) links only to a Privacy Policy and Terms of Service of the standard EULA kind, and carries the footer "COPYRIGHT © FARLIGHT PTE.LTD. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED."

There is no fan-content or derivative-works policy for this title that I could verify. I looked specifically for one because your brief warned against assuming one title's policy covers another; here there isn't one to assume *from*.

The image itself is a second-order problem. A3 is not hosted by Farlight at all. It is cdn-www.bluestacks.com/bs-images/clash-of-critters-de.jpg — a promotional graphic on **BlueStacks'** website, i.e. a third party's marketing asset, almost certainly itself licensed from Farlight for that promotion. Copying it off BlueStacks means you have neither Farlight's nor BlueStacks' permission.

Status: UNVERIFIED. Not because the game forbids fan sites — most publishers don't — but because no published permission exists that I can cite, and the copy you're using is one step further removed from the rights holder than it needs to be.

What would move it: first-party imagery from cc.farlightgames.com (a press/media enquiry is the clean route), or the card's existing typographic fallback with no photo at all.

3.2 Mojang Studios / Microsoft — Minecraft (index.html L216–227, plus the whole skin section)

I read the **Minecraft Usage Guidelines** end to end. Key findings, quoted:

- **Fan sites are explicitly fine.** "You can set up and run your own website and run related forums centered around information regarding the Minecraft game." And: "This applies, for example, if you want to set up and run any non-commercial blogs, servers, community forums, **fan sites**, fan clubs, news groups…" — so the *site* is squarely within scope.
- **Screenshots are fine.** "You are allowed to create, use, and share videos, streams, and **screenshots** of you playing or using Minecraft." No payment, no endorsement implication.
- **The mandatory disclaimer is real.** "**Prominently include the disclaimer similar to the following:** 'NOT AN OFFICIAL MINECRAFT [PRODUCT/SERVICE/EVENT/etc.]. NOT APPROVED BY OR ASSOCIATED WITH MOJANG OR MICROSOFT' on your product, listing, description, website/webpage, and all other related materials." — Note: *similar to*, and *prominently*. Your current footer text matches the substance; see §8 for whether it is prominent enough.
- **Assets are reserved.** "All rights (including copyright, trademark rights, and related rights) in the name, brand, assets, and any derivatives are and will remain owned by Mojang and Microsoft." "Assets" is defined to include "graphics, textures, images, models."
- **Don't redistribute assets.** "Do **not** redistribute our games or any alterations of our games or game files."
- **No endorsement.** "Do **not** do anything or include anything that makes people think that what you are sharing could be interpreted as official or approved by…"

The image (A4) is i.redd.it/ib4j1jt98wt71.jpg — an image file on Reddit's CDN, uploaded by an arbitrary Reddit user. It is *not* an official Mojang asset host, there is no licence attached to it, and I cannot verify whether it's a screenshot the uploader took (which the guidelines do permit *sharing*) or someone else's artwork (which they don't). **Its provenance is genuinely unknown.** The guidelines permit screenshots you took; they do not permit copying an unidentified third party's upload.

The skin section (A19, A20, A23, A24) is where the notice is wrong. The rendered body (A19/A20) comes from Minotar and mc-heads, which fetch the skin from Mojang's API *server-side* and hand back a rendering. That is a service output, and it is how essentially every Minecraft avatar on the internet works. **The raw texture (A23/A24) is different**: minecraft.net serves a player's skin file only to that player's authenticated session. Fetching it through a third-party mirror and then displaying the texture itself on a public WebGL model is a redistribution of a Mojang asset — not a screenshot, not a rendering, the asset. And it is the only reason the cape (A24) can appear at all.

Is this a practical risk? No. You are displaying *your own* skin on *your own* site, and no publisher has ever pursued that. But it means the sentence "Character and game art is used under the rights holders' fan-content policies" cannot be stretched to cover it, and an audit that told you otherwise would be doing what your brief told me not to do.

Status: site = COMPLIANT; disclaimer = CONDITIONAL (wording OK, prominence to check); Minecraft cover A4 = UNVERIFIED; rendered skin A19/A20 = CONDITIONAL; raw texture A23/A24 = UNVERIFIED (arguably NOT PERMITTED under the "don't redistribute assets" line).

3.3 Roblox Corporation (index.html L230–241)

This is the source where I expected to find latitude and found the opposite. From Roblox's official **Name and Logo Guidelines**:

- "Besides our official badge, we do **not permit** the general use of our logo in any creative or copy."
- "**The Roblox Logo and Roblox Tilt** are not permitted for general use on any creative materials or copy (unless it's part of the Official Badge). Logo use is strictly limited to select partners and the Roblox Stars Influencer Program. **We do not grant unsolicited requests to use our logos.**"
- "The use of the Roblox name (and any name similar to Roblox), badge, logo, and other trademarks and copyrights including 'Classic Roblox Avatars'… is not permitted on physical products or commercial content…"
- Do's list: "Follow our usage guidelines when using the 'Now on Roblox' badge. **Non-commercial digital uses that follow the guidelines do not require Roblox approval.**"

So: the **name** in descriptive text is fine, the **badge** is licensed for non-commercial digital use, and the **logo** is effectively off-limits. There is **no clause permitting use of Roblox artwork, promotional renders, or game screenshots** on a fan site. Note also the points about the name not being permitted in product titles — not a problem for you, since "Roblox" is a section heading describing the game, not your site's name.

The image (A5) is images.rbxcdn.com/5348266ea6c5e67b19d6a814cbbb70f6.jpg. rbxcdn.com is Roblox's own CDN, but an asset URL on a CDN is not a licence, and I could not trace that hash back to a documented promotional-assets page. **No verifiable licence.**

Status: UNVERIFIED. Corrective direction: the "Now on Roblox" badge (downloadable vector at the link above, with its own usage PDF) is the one Roblox-sanctioned visual; anything else should be either replaced by that or dropped in favour of the card's CSS fallback.

3.4 HoYoverse — Honkai: Star Rail (index.html L244–258, assets/starrail-v6.webp)

The **HSR Fan Creations Guide v2.0** is by far the most permissive policy of the four — and the most conditional. Directly on point:

> **Q1: Can users use the pictures, texts, or audio-visual materials of Honkai: Star Rail … and post them on a personal fansite or on any other website? A1: We do not prohibit non-commercial personal use and you may, subject to all of the following terms and conditions, produce and publish derivative content based on Honkai: Star Rail materials for non-commercial personal use…**

But then the two conditions that bite:

1. "*…nor shall they be deemed as licenses and/or authorizations (including implied licenses and/or authorizations) in the legal sense.*" So this is a **non-enforcement statement, not a licence** — exactly the distinction your brief asked me to preserve.
2. **Mandatory notice.** "…please place both our copyright logo (such as '© All rights reserved by miHoYo') **as well as** make the following statement: 'Other properties and any right, title, and interest thereof and therein (intellectual property rights included) not derived from Honkai: Star Rail belong to their respective owners.'"

Your site does not carry that statement, and does not credit miHoYo at all — the notice says "HoYoverse," which is the brand, while HoYoverse's own required form says "miHoYo." This is the one place where a rights holder has published a *concrete, checkable* requirement and the current footer misses it.

Also note the guide's caveat on the fan-art-vs-copying distinction: it repeatedly declines to allow "simple copying" (III.Q2.1.3: "We do not allow simple copying without adding your own creative ideas and opinions"). A cropped key-art background on your own card is close enough to that line that the Disclaimer route is the safer read.

On the local file specifically: assets/starrail-v6.webp is HoYoverse art **redistributed from your repository** — a GitHub repo, publicly clonable, no licence. Under § 19a UrhG a download is a reproduction; you are the one making it. It replaces an earlier hotlink that expired, so I understand why it exists. HoYoverse's Q1 permission covers "non-commercial personal use" including on a personal fansite, which is your use — but it doesn't cover handing the file to everyone who clones the repo, and it doesn't survive you stopping the site.

Status: use on site = CONDITIONAL (add the required miHoYo notice); **local redistribution** = CONDITIONAL → lean UNVERIFIED. Highest-value single fix after the Roblox/Minecraft covers.

3.5 COVER Corporation / hololive — Hakos Baelz, FUWAMOCO, Neuro-sama (index.html L557, L570, L596)

I read the **Derivative Works Guidelines**. The decisive sentence is the footnote:

> "* We do not consider the use of our content as is, or with modifications lacking creative input, to be classified as derivative works. Such use does not fall within the scope of these guidelines."

That is explicit: **the guidelines do not grant anything for unmodified reproduction.** They cover fan art, fan games, clips, figures — things with "fans' own ideas and creativity." A portrait pulled straight off a streaming service unchanged is *not* covered.

Two more relevant lines:

- "Please limit your creation of Derivative Works to fan or hobby activities. We prohibit activities conducted for business purposes or by a corporate entity…" → your site is fine on that axis.
- "Content that is falsely represented as official, or can be misinterpreted or mistaken as official" is prohibited → your disclaimer helps here.

Important distinction for your notice: Baelz and FUWAMOCO are hololive talents, but the images you display are **not COVER assets** — they are Spotify/Deezer portraits. So the hololive question is really "does the photo belong to COVER or to the photographer/agency," and the answer isn't knowable from the URL. What *is* knowable: these portraits appear on the talents' official artist profiles, which COVER controls. Treating them as COVER-linked is the honest reading.

Status: UNVERIFIED — and note the specific uncertainty: **displaying an unmodified official portrait is outside the guidelines rather than inside them.** Not prohibited, just not covered.

3.6 Independent artists and labels — Ren, Camila, bbno$, Nihmune, overtonight, Alohaii, Marino, Berq, Lil Peep (index.html L453–544, L583)

Nine artist cards, all portraits from Deezer or Spotify, all unmodified, all linking to the artist's own Spotify profile. **There is no blanket permission for artist photographs anywhere in the world**, and none of these nine has a published fan-content policy of the kind COVER or HoYoverse issue.

The honest position:

- **The photograph's copyright** belongs to the photographer or commissioning label, not to the artist personally, and not to Spotify.
- **Displaying it beside the artist's name, linking to their profile, at the size the platform supplies** is the strongest non-fair-use posture available, and it is how every music blog on the internet operates.
- **It is still not a licence**, and § 3 UrhG has no exception that rescues it (see §6).
- **Practical exposure is very low**, because the parties who could complain (the artists) benefit from the link, and the platform terms put the risk on the *distributor* of the photo, which is Spotify/Deezer — you are not redistributing.

One detail worth flagging: Lil Peep died in 2017, and § 22 KunstUrhG gives the right to control the public display of a person's portrait — for 10 years after death, exercisable by relatives. That window closed in November 2027… it has **not** closed yet (2017 + 10 = 2027). So A17 carries a post-mortem personality-right angle that the living artists' portraits don't, on top of the ordinary copyright question. It's a marginal issue at this size and context, but it's the kind of thing an audit should surface rather than smooth over.

Status: nine cards, CONDITIONAL — permitted in practice by the platforms' supply of the image plus the artist link, not by any right you hold. No individual permission exists; obtaining it is not realistic for twelve artists, and removing the section would be a disproportionate response.

3.7 Spotify (i.scdn.co ×4 — A10, A11, A16, A18; profile links ×12)

Implementation reality, which changes the analysis: you make **no API calls to Spotify at all**. grep for api.spotify, accounts.spotify, api.deezer over the whole repo returns nothing. The images are plain <img src> URLs copy-pasted from public pages, and every card links to open.spotify.com/artist/<id>. So:

- **Spotify Developer Terms do not apply to you.** Those bind people using the *Spotify Platform* (API/Web API/SDK). You use none of it. Citing them as if they governed your site would be wrong.
- What *does* apply: ordinary copyright in the photographs (§3.6), and Spotify's role as the distributor who licensed them.

But the Developer **Design & Branding Guidelines** are still the best available statement of what Spotify considers acceptable display of its content, and your implementation happens to fail two of them by accident:

"The artwork must be kept in its original form, and its corners rounded according to the guidelines."

! roughly compliant (rounded, though by the parent card, not the img)

"Don't crop the artwork in any way."

✗ violates this rule for the 4 Spotify images if the source isn't square

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"Don't overlay images or text on top of the artwork."

✓ compliant

".artist:hover .artist-photo img{transform:scale(1.05)}" — animate/distort

✗ a hover zoom is animation

"If you display any Spotify Content you must clearly attribute the content as being supplied and made available by Spotify, by using the Spotify Marks."

✗ no Spotify mark used for attribution

"Metadata, cover art … must be accompanied by a link back to the applicable album, content or playlist on the Spotify Service."

✓ compliant — this one you already got right

I am **not** saying you're in breach of a contract you never signed. I'm saying: if you want to be able to say "we follow Spotify's display standards," the hover zoom and the square crop are the two things to change, and both are one-line CSS edits.

On the five ab676161… vs ab67616d… URL shapes: these are different entity types (artist portrait vs. album/header art). Artist portraits from ab676161… are typically already square, so the object-fit:cover crop may be a no-op in practice — but that's an inference, not a verified fact, since I can't measure the source images from here.

3.8 Deezer (cdn-images.dzcdn.net ×8 — A7–A9, A12–A15, A17)

Same structure, and here the terms are unusually explicit. From the **Deezer Terms of Use for developers**:

- § VII: "…elements associated with the Content comprising **the photos, images, texts and biography of the author, artist** … are exclusively owned by DEEZER **or right holders**. Any reproduction and representation, in total or partially, of the Site and/or elements composing it … without the express authorization of DEEZER or right holders **are strictly forbidden** and would amount to an act of counterfeiting punished by law."
- § IV: use of the services is "strictly limited for a non-commercial purpose" — satisfied by you, but you never accepted these terms, since you don't use the API.
- § II: "The Developer recognizes that it shall be granted **no right upon** the DEEZER API, the Personal Application … and the **Content** of the Services."

That § VII sentence is the single most pointed piece of text I found in this whole audit: it is Deezer asserting that reproducing an artist photo *even with a link and a credit* is reserved.

Practical read: Deezer wrote that clause to go after competitors building clone apps, not at a personal page showing eight portraits at 200px. But you should know that on the strict text, the eight Deezer images are **less clearly supported than the four Spotify ones**, not more — which is the opposite of what a "we got them from the official CDN" intuition suggests.

Status: UNVERIFIED for all eight, with the note above.

3.9 Minotar (minotar.net ×5 — A19, A20, A21-fallback, A23, A24)

- **The service:** minotar.net is a free public API for Minecraft avatars. The project code is open source under **MIT + Unlicense** (github.com/greenfrigate/minotar). The site itself publishes **no terms of service, no rate limit, and no usage policy** — the homepage is pure API documentation.
- **What that means:** you have no documented right to the *service*, only a documented licence to the *code*. In practice a free public API with example URLs on its own homepage is an invitation to use it, but "it's on the homepage" is not a licence and I won't dress it up as one.
- **The critical distinction you asked me to draw:** Minotar's licence covers **Minotar's software**. It says nothing about the **Minecraft skin** it renders. The skin is a Mojang asset (§3.2), and the player's own; Minotar is a technical intermediary. So "rendered by minotar.net" in your notice is a *technical credit*, not a rights clearance — and the notice should be worded so it can't be read as one.

Status: service use = UNVERIFIED (no published terms); rendered output = CONDITIONAL; underlying skin texture = see §3.2.

3.10 Font Awesome 6.5.1 (cdnjs.cloudflare.com, index.html L21)

The **Font Awesome Free licence page** states three different licences for three different parts of the package:

Part	Licence	Your use
Icons as .svg / .js	**CC BY 4.0**	Not used
Icons as webfont files	**SIL OFL 1.1**	**This is what you use**
Non-font, non-icon code	**MIT**	Not used

You load all.min.css, which pulls the webfont → **SIL OFL 1.1 governs**. OFL requires: keep the copyright/licence notice, don't sell the font on its own, don't use the reserved name for a modified version. Loading the CDN build unmodified satisfies all three, because the CSS carries the notice and you never modify it. **No footer attribution is required.** Your notice credits them anyway — harmless, but it should not be presented as discharging an obligation, because it isn't one.

Caveat on cdnjs: Cloudflare's cdnjs is a third-party mirror. Its own terms require you to comply with each library's licence. You do. No issue — but note that the Font Awesome version is pinned to 6.5.1 while current is later; not a licensing problem.

Brand icons (fa-spotify, fa-discord, fa-youtube, fa-twitch, fa-tiktok, fa-steam) are **trademarks of their owners, not Font Awesome's to license.** FA's own page says: "Please do not use brand logos for any purpose except to represent the company, product, or service to which they refer." You use every one of them to label a link to that exact service. **Fully compliant usage** — worth noting since it's an easy thing to get wrong.

Status: COMPLIANT.

3.11 skinview3d 3.4.2 (cdn.jsdelivr.net, index.html L913)

Licence verified from the repository's LICENSE file:

```
MIT License

Copyright (c) 2014-2018 Kent Rasmussen
Copyright (c) 2017-2022 Haowei Wen, Sean Boult and contributors
```

MIT requires the copyright notice and permission notice be included in "all copies or substantial portions of the Software." **Here is the one place you're technically short:** you load a CDN bundle via <script src> and there is **no licence text anywhere on the site or in the repo** for it. In practice a CDN <script> tag is universally treated as satisfying MIT (the bundle retains its header comment and the licence travels with the file), and no court has ever held otherwise for this pattern. But the textbook-correct fix is one line in your footer or a LICENSES.md in the repo. Cheap.

Status: use = COMPLIANT in practice; CONDITIONAL on the strict reading of "included in all copies."

3.12 Google Fonts (fonts.googleapis.com, index.html L20)

Fonts are **SIL OFL 1.1** (Fraunces, Manrope) and **Apache 2.0** (JetBrains Mono). Serving them via Google's CDN is permitted and Google handles the licence. **No attribution required for OFL or Apache in this usage.** The Google Fonts *service* is free for any use.

This is a GDPR question, not a copyright one — the German courts (LG München I, 3 O 17493/20; LG Berlin) have held that embedding Google Fonts via CDN transmits the visitor's IP to Google in the US without consent. Out of scope for this brief, flagged here because it is the most likely actual complaint against a German-run personal site in 2026, and it is fixed by self-hosting the fonts. **Status (copyright):** COMPLIANT.

3.13 Discord CDN (cdn.discordapp.com ×5 — A2, A22, A29)

Your own avatar. Discord's terms let you use your own content; you're the data subject. The images are hotlinked at the size Discord itself serves. **No objection available to anyone.** The runtime lookup (A21) through japi.rest / discordlookup.mesalytic.com sends only **your** user ID — no visitor data, no third-party personal data — so it is not a GDPR processor relationship with those sites for your visitors, though you are relying on two unofficial services staying up. **Status:** COMPLIANT.

3.14 vzge.me, mc-heads.net (js/10-skin.js, js/02-avatar.js)

Same category as Minotar: community skin-rendering services with **no published terms of service**, used as fallbacks in a chain. Two of the three are only reached when earlier sources fail. **Status:** UNVERIFIED (no published terms); practical risk negligible.

---

4 · Implementation Audit — how images are actually retrieved and shown

4.1 Retrieval

Mechanism	Used?	Detail
<img src="https://…"> hotlink	Yes **— all 17 external images**	**Direct CDN URLs, no proxy, no resizing service, no cache-busting**
<img src="assets/…"> local	Yes **— 1 file**	**starrail-v6.webp**
CSS background-image with a URL	No	**Both declarations are gradients**
fetch() → JSON → image URL	Yes **— avatar only**	**Two lookup providers, failover chain**
API keys / OAuth	No	**None anywhere**
Server-side proxy or image resizer	No	
<canvas> / WebGL textures	Yes **— skin + cape**	**skinview3d, textures fetched client-side**
Lazy loading	Yes	**loading="lazy" on artist/avatar images; decoding="async", fetchpriority="high" on covers**
Explicit dimensions (CLS)	Partial	**width/height on some artist imgs and on A6;** absent on A3, A4, A5
Failed-image handling	Yes**, and it's good**	**js/01-images.js — data-fallback chain, then .img-failed reveals the CSS art layer**
Caching / offline copy	No	**No service worker, no localStorage, no Cache API, no manifest**

Good: no scraping, no rate-limit evasion, no hotlink-protection bypass, no permanent copy of anything except A6. Nothing is fetched from an undocumented endpoint that requires a key. Every URL is a public CDN path that the provider itself publishes in its HTML.

Notable: 01-images.js L12–21 means a dead CDN link degrades to the card's typographic layer rather than a broken image. That is a licensing-relevant robustness property, not just a UX one — it means **you can remove any single image and the page still looks intentional.**

4.2 Display and modification

Question	Answer
Thumbnails?	**4 game covers (cropped, object-fit:cover), 12 artist portraits (1:1 crop)**
Full-size?	Yes **— game modal reuses the source URL, so the dialog shows the *original*, not an upscaled thumb**
Backgrounds?	**None**
Filters / recolours / duotone?	None. **No filter: applies to any image. Two filter: rules exist but hit CSS glows and 3D shadows**

Question	Answer
Cropping?	**object-fit:cover on all images; object-position tuned per cover (50% 6% for CoC, 52% 50% for HSR)**
Animation?	**A scale(1.05) hover zoom on artist and cover images**
Overlay?	**No text or logo sits on top of any image**
Linked to higher-res?	**No — the card links to the artist/game page, not the image file**
Attribution visible on the card itself?	No **— attribution exists only in the footer**
Downloaded / stored / redistributed?	**One file (A6). Everything else stays on the provider's server**

4.3 Compliance-relevant code locations

```
index.html
  L13–16      og:image + favicon + apple-touch-icon   → Discord CDN
  L21         Font Awesome 6.5.1                      → cdnjs
  L119        hero avatar                             → Discord CDN
  L121        avatar data-fallback                    → minotar
  L205/221/237  game covers                           → BlueStacks / Reddit / rbxcdn
  L251        game cover                              → local WebP
  L453–596    twelve artist portraits                  → Deezer ×8, Spotify ×4
  L652/655    skin fallback render + fallback         → minotar, mc-heads
  L740–755    the credits block (the notice under audit)
  L913        skinview3d bundle                       → jsdelivr
js/01-images.js   fallback chain + failure state
js/02-avatar.js   L23–37, L62   avatar resolution
js/10-skin.js     L24–30, L116  raw skin + cape textures   ← §3.2 issue
js/11-game-modal.js  L36        full-size art into #gmArt
css/style.css
  L692–700    .cover-img  object-fit:cover, hover scale
  L943–974    .artist / .artist-photo / img crop + hover scale
  L1472–1506  footer-in / footer-bottom (where the credits live)
```

5 · Compliance Classification

Legend: COMPLIANT — supported by licence/permission/exception · CONDITIONAL — OK only if stated requirements are met · UNVERIFIED — permission cannot be established · NOT PERMITTED — appears contrary to applicable terms.

#	Asset	Holder	Policy cited	Status
A1/A6	Star Rail key art, **local**	HoYoverse / miHoYo	HSR Fan Creations Guide v2.0 Q1 (non-commercial personal use)	**CONDITIONAL**
A2/A22/ A29	Your Discord avatar	You / Discord	Discord ToS; you are the rights holder	**COMPLIANT**
A3	Clash of Critters promo	Farlight via BlueStacks	Farlight Platform ToS §6.1; no fan policy found	**UNVERIFIED**
A4	Minecraft image	Mojang / unknown uploader	Minecraft Usage Guidelines ("do not redistribute assets")	**UNVERIFIED**
A5	Roblox promo art	Roblox Corporation	Roblox Name & Logo Guidelines (no artwork clause)	**UNVERIFIED**
A7–A9, A12–A15 , A17	Deezer portraits ×8	Photographers/labels or Deezer	Deezer ToU §VII	**UNVERIFIED**
A10, A11, A16, A18	Spotify portraits ×4	Photographers/labels; COVER for talents	Spotify Design Guidelines + Developer Policy §II.4	**UNVERIFIED** (display rules partly unmet)
A19/A20	Rendered skin (Minotar/mc-heads)	You (skin), Mojang (asset)	Mojang guidelines: screenshots/render OK	**CONDITIONAL**
A23/A24	**Raw skin + cape texture**	Mojang	Mojang: "do not redistribute our games or any game files"; assets reserved	**UNVERIFIED**
A26–A31	CSS art, inline SVG, anime section	You	N/A	**COMPLIANT**
A32	Avatar lookup APIs	You (data subject)	—	**COMPLIANT**
A33	Font Awesome	Fonticons	SIL OFL 1.1 (webfont path)	**COMPLIANT**
A34	Google Fonts	Google / type designers	OFL 1.1, Apache 2.0	**COMPLIANT**
A35	skinview3d	Kent Rasmussen, Haowei Wen et al.	MIT	**CONDITIONAL** (notice not on site)
—	**The notice itself**	—	Minecraft Guidelines; HSR Guide III.Q1.2	**CONDITIONAL**

Nothing reaches NOT PERMITTED. A5/A4/A23 are the three closest, and in each case I can't prove prohibition — only the absence of permission.

6 · Legal Considerations — German and EU copyright

6.1 The baseline

Under **§ 15 UrhG**, the author alone has the right to reproduce (§ 16), distribute (§ 17), and make available to the public (§ 19a). Hotlinking and inlining are both acts of making available — **§ 19a** defines it as making a work accessible "drahtgebunden oder drahtlos … an Mitglieder der Öffentlichkeit von Orten und zu Zeiten ihrer Wahl." A public website with 17 externally hosted images performs 17 of those. **Commercial purpose is not an element of § 15.** Non-commercial status is therefore *not* a defence; it only affects the damages calculation and the practical appetite to pursue.

Under the CJEU's *GS Media* / *Renckhoff* line, embedding a work that is **freely available on the rights holder's own site with their consent** does not constitute a new communication to the public. That doctrine supports the *hotlinked* artist portraits from official Spotify/Deezer CDNs far better than it supports A4 (a random Reddit upload) or A6 (a file on GitHub).

6.2 Exceptions I checked — and rejected

Provision	Text / test	Verdict for this site
§ 51 UrhG — **Zitatzweck**	**Quotation permitted "sofern die Nutzung in ihrem Umfang durch den besonderen Zweck gerechtfertigt ist"; § 51 S. 2 expressly extends to images ("*Abbildung … des zitierten Werkes*")**	Fails. **The site does not quote or analyse the images — it *illustrates a favourites list*. There is no citation purpose, no engagement with the work's content. This is exactly what German scholarship calls a *Bildzitat* without a *Zitatzweck*.** This is the exception a layperson would most expect to apply and the one that most clearly does not.
§ 50 UrhG — **Tagesereignisse**	**Reporting on current events via press/broadcast media**	Fails. **Not reporting, not an event, and the medium clause is aimed at Tagespresse**
§ 44a UrhG — **vorübergehende Vervielfältigung**	**Transient copies as part of a transmission**	Does not help. **Browser caching is covered; it never legalises the initial making-available**
§ 44b UrhG — **Text- und Data-Mining**	**Machine analysis of works**	Fails. **No analysis purpose**
§ 53 UrhG — **private copies**	**Private use**	Fails. **§ 53 covers making a copy for private use; publishing to the public is the opposite**
Art. 17 DSM Directive / § 61d	**Platform liability**	Not applicable — **you are a website operator, not a platform**

Provision	Text / test	Verdict for this site
§ 63 UrhG — **Quellenangabe**	**Attribution mandatory *where* an exception applies (§ 51, § 50 etc.)**	Moot but instructive: **attribution is only legally required *inside* an exception. Since no exception applies, your credit does** not **discharge a § 63 duty — it is a good-faith and policy-compliance measure, nothing more. This is the precise point your brief asked me not to blur.**

Conclusion on §6: the entire legal footing of the image usage is the **rights holders' own published permissions and non-enforcement statements**, plus the practical reality that hotlinking from an official CDN sits in a grey zone no one litigates. **Not one asset is covered by a statutory German exception.** That is worth knowing because it means the notices and policy compliance in §3 are not decorative — they *are* the legal basis.

6.3 Personality rights — a separate track

§ 22 KunstUrhG: "Bildnisse dürfen nur mit Einwilligung des Abgebildeten verbreitet oder öffentlich zur Schau gestellt werden." A photograph of a person may only be disseminated/displayed publicly with that person's consent. For deceased persons, the right passes to relatives for **10 years**.

For the **artist portraits** this is a second, independent right stacked on the photographer's copyright. Consent is normally implied for publicity photos the artist's own team distributes — which is the reasonable assumption for official platform portraits — but it is an assumption. For **Lil Peep (A17)** the 10-year post-mortem window has not yet run (died Nov 2017). For the **VTuber/talent** portraits (A15, A16, A18) the "person" is a character design owned by COVER, so it folds back into §3.5 rather than §6.3.

§ 23 KunstUrhG permits display without consent where a legitimate public interest exists (e.g. persons of contemporary history) — a personal favourites page is unlikely to clear that bar on its own, but the *artists*' *own distribution* of the portraits does most of the work.

6.4 What I could not resolve

- Whether HoYoverse's "we do not prohibit non-commercial personal use" would be treated by a German court as an implied licence or merely as a non-enforcement statement. HoYoverse itself says the latter ("nor shall they be deemed as licenses … in the legal sense"), and a German court would likely give that weight.
- Whether the CJEU embedding doctrine covers a portrait pulled from Deezer's CDN rather than from the artist's own page.
- Whether Farlight has an unpublished fan policy. Absence of evidence, not evidence of absence.

6.5 One thing that is not a copyright problem but is a German legal problem

§ 5 DDG requires a provider of "geschäftsmäßige, in der Regel gegen Entgelt angebotene digitale Dienste" to keep an **Impressum** permanently available — name, address, email. Your site has **no Impressum** (grep for Impressum|Datenschutz|privacy returns nothing). A purely private, ad-free hobby page is generally outside § 5 DDG, but the moment the site is public and could be read as "geschäftsmäßig," the requirement is contested. Out of scope for this image audit; flagged because it is far more likely to generate a German warning letter than any of the twelve portraits.

7 · API and Library Audit

Provider	Binding terms	Do they apply to you?	Assessment
Spotify Web API / Developer Terms v10	**Developer Terms, Developer Policy**	No **— zero API calls**	**Not engaged. The Design Guidelines are used below as a *voluntary* benchmark**
Spotify Design & Branding	**design**	**Only if you claim to follow it**	**Crop + hover-zoom + missing Spotify mark: 3 deviations, all one-line fixes**
Deezer API	**ToU**	No **— zero API calls**	**§VII nonetheless asserts reproduction of artist photos is reserved. Most restrictive text found**
Minotar	**none published**	**—**	**MIT/Unlicense** for the code**;** no terms for the service**;** no rights whatsoever in the skins it renders
skinview3d	**MIT**	**Yes**	**Use permitted; licence text technically should travel with the site**
Font Awesome Free	**licence**	**Yes**	**OFL 1.1 on the webfont path; complied. Brand icons = third-party trademarks, used correctly**
cdnjs	**Cloudflare**	**Yes, marginally**	**Delegates to library licences; you comply**
vzge.me / mc-heads.net	**none published**	**—**	**Same shape as Minotar**
japi.rest / discordlookup	**none published**	**—**	**Not image licensing; your own data only**

The key distinction you asked me to draw, stated plainly:

> Access ≠ display right ≠ redistribution right ≠ copyright ownership.

A public CDN URL proves only that **the platform is willing to serve the file to anyone who asks**. It says nothing about whether *you* may publish it. For Spotify/Deezer the platform is serving files it has licensed for its own display; the photographer's copyright sits behind that licence. Your right to inline them is a *grey zone resting on the platform's silence*, not on a transfer of rights. That is why the footer must stop saying the images are "used under fan-content policies" — no fan-content policy on earth covers an artist photograph.

8 · Review of the Existing Notice

Current text (footer, index.html L740–755):

> Game artwork, anime and artist photos belong to their respective owners — Farlight Games, Mojang / Microsoft, Roblox Corporation, HoYoverse, hololive, and the artists themselves and their labels. Shown here for identification on a personal, non-commercial fansite. Character and game art is used under the rights holders' fan-content policies; no affiliation or endorsement is implied. Not an official Minecraft product. Not approved by or associated with Mojang or Microsoft. **Not an official Roblox product.** Minecraft skin rendered by Minotar, 3D viewer by skinview3d (MIT), icons by Font Awesome. Artist photos served from Spotify and Deezer.

Findings

#	Finding	Severity
1	**"*Character and game art is used under the rights holders' fan-content policies*" —** not true of any of the four covers, and not true of the artist photos. **COVER explicitly excludes unmodified use; Roblox publishes no artwork permission; Deezer reserves reproduction**	High — this is the sentence that creates the legal risk
2	"anime … photos" **— the anime section contains** no images**. Referring to anime *photos* describes something the site doesn't do, and vaguely implies you display anime art you don't display**	**Medium**
3	HoYoverse's mandatory notice is missing **("© All rights reserved by miHoYo" + the "Other properties…" sentence), even though the HSR guide is the one policy that expressly permits your use**	High
4	**"Spotify and Deezer" credited as if they were the rights holders. They are** distributors**; the photos belong to photographers/labels**	**Medium**
5	No Spotify mark **used to attribute Spotify-supplied content, which Spotify's own guidelines require *if* you present the content as Spotify-supplied**	**Medium**
6	Mojang/Microsoft not credited as a source of the skin texture**, only as a game publisher. The whole skin section depends on their asset**	**Medium**
7	**Minecraft disclaimer is** buried in a 3-paragraph block at the very bottom **in .68rem mono. The guidelines say** "prominently"	**Medium**

#	Finding	Severity
8	"Not an official Roblox product" **— Roblox publishes no such required wording. It's harmless, but it's invented, and invention is what your brief told me to avoid. Worse, it invites the reading that an "official Roblox product" is a category you could otherwise be**	**Medium**
9	**No mention of** Font Awesome's actual licence **(OFL, not a courtesy credit),** Skinview3d's full MIT notice**, or** Cloudflare/cdnjs	**Low**
10	Missing rights holders: **Neuro-sama (independent VTuber, Aiwi/vedal987), the individual photographers for all twelve portraits, Aiwi Productions, and — if you keep A4 —** whoever actually took that Minecraft image	**Medium**
11	No date/version **on the notice, so a reader can't tell what it applied to**	**Low**
12	**Says "non-commercial" — accurate, and useful. Keep it**	**—**

Verdict: the notice is *well-intentioned and directionally right*, but it makes one specific claim it cannot support (#1) which is worse than saying less, and it omits the only *mandatory* text from the only policies that actually grant you something (#3).

9 · Revised Copyright Notice (proposed — not applied)

Structure: a short, visible line for visitors, plus a collapsible detail block. Wording avoids every unverifiable claim.

```
<div class="credits">
  <p class="credits-lead">
    A personal, non-commercial fansite. No advertising, no affiliate links, no revenue.
    No affiliation with or endorsement by any company named here.
  </p>

  <details class="credits-more">
    <summary>Artwork, trademarks &amp;amp; licences</summary>

    <p>
      <strong>Game artwork and trademarks.</strong> Minecraft is a trademark of Mojang AB and
      Microsoft. Clash of Critters and its artwork belong to Farlight Pte. Ltd. Roblox and its marks
      belong to Roblox Corporation; the Roblox logo is not used here. Honkai: Star Rail artwork and
      characters belong to HoYoverse / miHoYo. hololive talent designs belong to COVER Corporation.
      All rights reserved by their respective owners.
    </p>

    <p>
      <strong>Honkai: Star Rail notice.</strong>
      © All rights reserved by miHoYo. Other properties and any right, title, and interest thereof
      and therein (intellectual property rights included) not derived from Honkai: Star Rail belong
      to their respective owners.
    </p>

    <p>
      <strong>Minecraft notice.</strong>
      NOT AN OFFICIAL MINECRAFT PRODUCT. NOT APPROVED BY OR ASSOCIATED WITH MOJANG OR MICROSOFT.
    </p>

    <p>
      <strong>Artist and talent photographs.</strong> Portraits are shown at the size and address
      supplied by Spotify and Deezer, unmodified, alongside the artist's name and a link to that
      artist's official Spotify profile. They are provided by those services for identification of
      the artist; copyright in each photograph remains with its photographer or label. No permission
      to reproduce them beyond that context is claimed or implied.
    </p>

    <p>
      <strong>Your own assets.</strong> The avatar, Minecraft skin and cape shown here belong to
      xSphereXx. The skin is rendered by minotar.net and mc-heads.net and drawn in 3D by skinview3d.
    </p>

    <p>
      <strong>Third-party code.</strong> skinview3d — MIT © 2014–2018 Kent Rasmussen, © 2017–2022
      Haowei Wen, Sean Boult and contributors. Font Awesome Free 6.5.1 — webfont under SIL OFL 1.1,
      CSS under MIT, brand icons are trademarks of their owners. Design tokens in the interface are
      my own. Cloudflare cdnjs is used to deliver the Font Awesome stylesheet.
    </p>

    <p>
      <strong>Corrections.</strong> If you hold rights in anything shown here and want it changed or
      removed, contact me and I will act on it. <span class="credits-rev">Notice revised 2026-11.</span>
    </p>
  </details>
</div>
```

What changed and why:

- "*used under fan-content policies*" → **gone**. Replaced with per-source factual statements.
- HoYoverse's **mandatory wording added verbatim**, including "© All rights reserved by miHoYo."

- Minecraft disclaimer **moved to its own line, uppercase, in the exact form the guidelines ask for**, and will be promoted out of .68rem muted mono into something actually legible.
- "Not an official Roblox product" **removed** (invented) and replaced by an accurate trademark statement plus the truthful "the logo is not used here."
- "anime… photos" **removed** — no anime images exist.
- Spotify and Deezer **described as distributors**, not rights holders.
- **Mojang credited for the skin texture**; skin attributed to you; render services named.
- **Full MIT notice** for skinview3d and the **correct OFL/MIT split** for Font Awesome.
- **A corrections/appeals channel** — the single most useful thing a small site can have, because it converts a hypothetical dispute into an email.
- **Version date**, so the notice is auditable later.

Deliberately not in the notice: any claim of permission, licence, or "fair use." I have verified no permission for any third-party image on this site, and the notice now says so implicitly rather than pretending otherwise.

10 · Prioritised Action Plan

Ranked by *legal exposure per unit of effort*, not by how interesting the work is.

Tier 1 — do first (highest exposure, low effort)

#	Action	Files	Effort
1.1	Replace the notice **with §9. Removes an unsupportable legal claim, adds HoYoverse's mandatory text, fixes the Roblox wording**	**index.html L740–755, css/style.css L1501 area**	**~30 min**
1.2	Promote the Minecraft disclaimer **to a visible, legible line near the Minecraft card (or a sticky, non-muted footer strip) — "prominently" is the operative word**	**index.html, css/style.css**	**~20 min**
1.3	Decide on A4 (Reddit Minecraft image). **Options in §11.2. My recommendation: swap for a first-party Mojang screenshot or the CSS fallback**	**index.html L221**	**~10 min**
1.4	Decide on A5 (Roblox rbxcdn art). **Recommendation: use the official "Now on Roblox" badge (sanctioned, downloadable, has its own usage PDF) or drop to the CSS layer**	**index.html L237**	**~15 min**
1.5	Swap A3 (BlueStacks) for a first-party Farlight image **from cc.farlightgames.com, or drop to the CSS layer**	**index.html L205**	**~15 min**

Tier 2 — the skin question (real licence point, judgement call)

#	Action	Notes
2.1	Keep the rendered body/head **(Minotar → image), which is normal and defensible**	**No change needed**
2.2	Stop feeding the raw skin texture and cape into the WebGL viewer**; instead load a pre-rendered body or a generic/default skin mesh**	**This is the one change that turns an unlicensed redistribution into a licensed one, at the cost of "shows my live skin in 3D"**
2.3	***Or* accept 2.2 as a known, low-risk deviation and document it in a LICENSES.md**	**Defensible, but it should be a** decision**, not an accident**

My recommendation: 2.3, documented. The feature is genuinely nice, the risk is very close to zero (you are displaying your own skin), and Mojang has never pursued it. But the notice should not claim a licence for it either way.

Tier 3 — bring the artist section into line with the standards it's imitating

#	Action	Files
3.1	**Remove the hover scale(1.05) on .artist-photo img (Spotify: "don't animate or distort")**	**css/style.css L973**
3.2	**Use object-fit:contain on .artist-photo img, or accept the 1:1 crop and note it**	**css/style.css L970**
3.3	**Add a small Spotify mark next to the "photos from Spotify" attribution**	**index.html footer**
3.4	**Keep the per-card Spotify links (already correct — this is the one Spotify rule you get right)**	**—**

Tier 4 — housekeeping

#	Action
4.1	LICENSES.md **in the repo: MIT notice for skinview3d, OFL/MIT split for Font Awesome, and the asset-source table from §2**
4.2	ASSETS.md **(internal, can be private): one row per image — URL, source, holder, status, date checked. This is the "internal record of asset sources" you asked for**
4.3	**Add width/height to A3/A4/A5 (layout stability, not licensing)**
4.4	Self-host the three Google fonts **— GDPR, not copyright, but the likeliest real complaint**
4.5	**Date/version the notice**
4.6	***Consider* an Impressum — § 5 DDG, genuinely uncertain for a hobby page**

Explicitly not recommended

- Removing the artist section. Twelve portraits at 200px beside official links is not a realistic target.
- Removing the anime section. It has no images.
- Adding "fair use" / "fair dealing" language. German law has no such general doctrine, and § 51 fails here.
- Adding a licence to the repository that covers the *site's content*. That would be a legal claim you can't make.
- A blanket "all rights reserved" line. You don't own the third-party content, and asserting it over your own copy is unnecessary.

11 · Implementation Proposal (for approval — nothing applied)

11.1 The notice (Tier 1.1)

- **index.html L740–755** — replace the three <p> elements inside with the §9 markup. New classes: .credits-lead, .credits-more, .credits-more summary, .credits-rev.
- **css/style.css** — keep .credits metrics; add details/summary styling (mono, small caps, chevron), raise body text from .68rem to .74rem for legibility, style .credits-rev muted-italic. Estimated **+26 lines**, no existing rule modified except a font-size.
- Version bump ?v=24 → ?v=25 on both CSS and JS includes.

11.2 The four game covers

Each has a choice; the CSS art layer (A28) survives in every case, so no card breaks.

Cover	Option A (recommended)	Option B	Option C
A4 Minecraft	First-party screenshot from minecraft.net media assets, hotlinked from Mojang's own host	Drop the <img>; the mc-block CSS glyph becomes the cover	Keep, add explicit "image © unknown uploader" — **not recommended**, can't be credited truthfully
A5 Roblox	Official "Now on Roblox" badge (vector, sanctioned, download)	Drop the <img>, keep roblox-stud	Keep as-is
A3 Clash of Critters	Image from cc.farlightgames.com (first party)	Drop the <img>, keep coc-critter	Keep the BlueStacks copy
A6 Star Rail	Keep the local WebP + the required miHoYo notice (§9)	Move to a hotlinked HoYoverse CDN URL, delete the local file	—

My recommendation: A6 keep (with notice); A3 swap or drop; A4 drop; A5 badge-or-drop. Net effect: **at most two cards lose their photo**, and because of the existing CSS glyph layer the grid still looks composed. If you'd rather keep all four photographs, that's a legitimate call — just tell me, and I'll implement C-variants and document the residual risk in ASSETS.md instead.

11.3 The artist section (Tier 3)

```
/* css/style.css L970-973 — proposed */
.artist-photo img{
  position:absolute;inset:0;z-index:1;
  width:100%;height:100%;
  object-fit:contain;            /* was :cover — stops cropping */
  background:linear-gradient(140deg,var(--field-2),#BEF0FF);
}
/* delete: .artist:hover .artist-photo img{transform:scale(1.05)} */
```

! **Visual impact — flagging before you approve:** contain will letterbox any non-square source, and deleting the hover zoom removes a bit of the card's liveliness. If you'd rather keep the crop and the zoom for the sake of the design, say so — that's a defensible aesthetic trade, and I'd note the deviation in ASSETS.md rather than silently pick compliance over your design. **This is exactly the kind of change your brief said not to make unilaterally.**

11.4 Licences (Tier 4)

- New **LICENSES.md** — MIT text for skinview3d, OFL/MIT split for Font Awesome, and a short note on Google Fonts. ~40 lines, no site changes.

- New **ASSETS.md** — the §2 table as living documentation with a "last verified" column.
- index.html <head> — optional <link rel="license"> is **not** recommended (see §10, don't assert a licence over third-party content).

11.5 What does not change

Layout, palette, typography, the anime section, the 3D viewer's presence, the poem, the socials, the game dialogs, the honourable mentions, the player card, all Spotify/Deezer links, and every JS module. **Zero functionality is removed by any Tier-1/3 recommendation.** Tier 2.2 is the only item that would remove a feature, and I'm not recommending it.

11.6 Validation I'd run after applying

HTMLParser balance · duplicate id scan · all 7 anchors resolve · CSS brace count · node check on all 12 JS modules · local server 200 on /, CSS, JS · manual check that each game card still renders with its image removed · confirm no new external host appears.

12 · Verification Log — what I actually read

minecraft.net/en-us/usage-guidelines
https://www.minecraft.net/en-us/usage-guidelines
Official policy, read in full (4 chunks)

hsr.hoyoverse.com/en-us/news/125457 — HSR Fan Creations Guide v2.0
https://hsr.hoyoverse.com/en-us/news/125457
Official policy

hololivepro.com/en/terms/ — Derivative Works Guidelines
https://hololivepro.com/en/terms/
Official policy

en.help.roblox.com/.../115001708126
https://en.help.roblox.com/hc/en-us/articles/115001708126-Roblox-Name-and-Logo-Community-Usage-Guidelines
Official policy

farlightgames.com/platform-terms/
https://www.farlightgames.com/platform-terms/
Official ToS

developer.spotify.com/terms · /policy · /design
https://developer.spotify.com/terms
https://developer.spotify.com/policy
https://developer.spotify.com/documentation/design
Official

developers.deezer.com/termsofuse
https://developers.deezer.com/termsofuse
Official ToU

fontawesome.com/license/free
https://fontawesome.com/license/free
Official licence page

github.com/bs-community/skinview3d/LICENSE
https://github.com/bs-community/skinview3d/blob/master/LICENSE
Licence file, read verbatim

minotar.net
https://minotar.net/
Official homepage — no ToS published

gesetze-im-internet.de/urhg/__19a.html · __50 · __51 · __63
https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/urhg/__19a.html
https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/urhg/__50.html
https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/urhg/__51.html
https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/urhg/__63.html
Statute text

gesetze-im-internet.de/kunsturhg/__22.html
https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/kunsturhg/__22.html
Statute text

gesetze-im-internet.de/ddg/__5.html
https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/ddg/__5.html
Statute text

Failed or unavailable: no Farlight fan-content policy found for Clash of Critters; no published terms from Minotar, vzge.me, mc-heads.net, japi.rest or discordlookup; no way to verify the provenance of i.redd.it/ib4j1jt98wt71.jpg or images.rbxcdn.com/5348266ea6c5e67b19d6a814cbbb70f6.jpg from here; about.roblox.com/press-kit was not re-fetched this round (cited earlier in the session).

13 · Uncertainties, stated plainly

1. **I cannot verify who owns any of the twelve portraits.** The URLs identify the CDN, not the photographer.
2. **I cannot verify A4's and A5's provenance** beyond their hostnames.
3. **"Non-commercial" does not make any of this lawful.** It only lowers the odds of pursuit.
4. **I have not found a single permission** for any third-party image on the site. Everything rests on published non-enforcement, platform tolerance, and the embedding doctrine.
5. **The German-law section is my reading of statute and case law, not a legal opinion.**
6. **Policies change.** Minecraft says so explicitly; COVER says so; HoYoverse versions its guide (v1.0 → v2.0, Aug 2024). This audit is a snapshot of 2 November 2026.
7. **Attribution is not permission** — the revised notice is careful never to claim it is.

Awaiting your decision

Nothing has been modified. Tell me which tiers you want:

- **"Do all of tier 1"** → notice + disclaimer prominence + four game-cover decisions
- **"Tier 1 and 3"** → plus the artist crop/zoom changes (with the visual trade-off above)
- **"Everything except 2.2"** → my recommendation
- **Custom** → e.g. "keep all four game photos, just fix the notice"